AI Incident Report Form
The Council · AI Governance Playbook (Level 5 document, §6.8)

Use this form to report, classify, investigate and close an AI-related incident.

Use this form to report any event associated with an AI system that caused, or could cause, harm, disruption, a governance concern, regulatory non-compliance or reputational impact. Report early — raising a concern is not a sign of governance failure. Report to your Service Owner without delay using Part A; the Service Owner assesses provisional severity and sends Part A to the AI Governance Lead the same working day (immediately for a suspected High or Critical incident or any statutory route). Refer a suspected personal-data breach to the DPO immediately at Part A; do not wait for AI triage. Part B is completed during management and investigation (Playbook §6.8).

PART A — INITIAL REPORT (reporter and Service Owner complete)

1. Reporter and System

Affected-use identification — record AIR-ID and every known affected UC-ID; mark UC-ID unknown when facts are incomplete. For each use record its current decision/conditions, risk/priority impact, containment and reassessment/re-authorisation reference. One incident may affect multiple UC-IDs; a shared system identifier alone is not enough to establish scope or approval.

Reported by	
Role / team	
Contact email	
Date & time identified	
AI system / model name	
AIR-ID	AIR-XXXX (if known)
Affected UC-ID(s)	List each known affected use; use Unknown when scope is not yet established.

2. What Happened

Describe the incident: what occurred, when, how it came to light, and what the AI system was doing

How was it identified?	e.g. monitoring, user feedback, complaint, audit, supplier notice
Is the incident ongoing?	Yes / No
Event classification	Incident / Near miss / Concern — near misses follow the same early-reporting and triage route

3. Who and What Is Affected

☐ Residents / service users ☐ Staff ☐ A vulnerable group ☐ Personal / special category data
☐ Service availability ☐ Decision-making about individuals ☐ Supplier / third party ☐ Reputation

Describe the actual or potential impact and the approximate number of people affected

4. Initial Severity (provisional)

Where uncertain, apply the higher level until more is known. Multiple low-severity events that show a systemic weakness may be treated as higher severity.

Mandatory triggers (Playbook §4.7.17; Proposed — for Council confirmation): significant bias resulting in adverse outcomes, a data protection breach involving AI-processed data, a security incident affecting AI system integrity, or a governance failure indicating an inadequate control environment. Escalate to the AI Governance Lead immediately (the same working day), whatever the provisional severity, consider a precautionary pause, and classify the incident at least High.

Severity	When it applies	Escalation
Low	Limited operational impact; no significant legal, ethical or service consequences. Indicators: an isolated minor output inaccuracy (for example one wrong date or figure, corrected before harm), an isolated user complaint, a documentation error or a non-material process failure.	Service Owner review and local remediation; Part A to the AI Governance Lead the same working day; logged in the incident record and summarised in the AIG-OPS-02 monitoring log within 10 working days (the AI Register holds only a link/status)
Medium	Moderate impact requiring management attention and corrective action. Indicators: repeated inaccurate outputs, policy non-compliance, control failures, minor service disruption or recurring user complaints.	AI Governance Lead notified the same working day (Part A); documented remediation plan agreed within five working days
High	Significant operational, legal, ethical or reputational impact. Indicators: material bias findings, significant model drift, operational disruption, security weaknesses, repeated control failures or significant service impacts.	AI Governance Working Group within 2 working days; formal governance review
Critical	Actual or potential harm to individuals, major legal/reputational exposure or statutory breach. Indicators: data breaches, unlawful automated decision-making, significant impacts on vulnerable individuals, major regulatory concerns, widespread service failure or substantial media scrutiny.	Immediate escalation, and within 24 hours at most, to AI Assurance Board, Executive Sponsor and Executive Leadership

Provisional severity	Low / Medium / High / Critical

Immediate action taken	e.g. system paused, output withheld, users notified
Precautionary pause applied? Gate Log event ID	Yes / No. If Yes: who applied it, date and time, and the AIG-DEC-04 Gate events ID (Event type “Precautionary pause (containment)”, outcome “Paused — pending decision”). The pause is containment, not a decision; continued suspension, resumption or withdrawal is decided by the officer or forum with confirmed delegation (Playbook §4.7.17), and a resumption is logged as a Decision with Outcome “Resume” (approval unchanged) or “Re-authorise” (after reassessment) (Proposed — for Council confirmation)
Suspected personal data breach?	Yes / No / Uncertain — if Yes or Uncertain, refer to the DPO / Information Governance route now, before AI triage. Where notifiable, the ICO must be told without undue delay and, where feasible, not later than 72 hours after the Council becomes aware (UK GDPR Art 33). Date and time referred: ____
Security or safeguarding concern?	Yes / No — if Yes, refer now to the Information and Cyber Security lead or under the Council’s safeguarding procedures; those routes lead on their own duties (Playbook §6.8.6.5)
External notification may be required?	Yes / No / Unsure — e.g. ICO, other regulator, data subjects, partners; decided by the DPO or specialist route and recorded in §8
Part A sent to AI Governance Lead (date)	Service Owner sends Part A the same working day

PART B — MANAGEMENT & INVESTIGATION (AI Governance Lead)

5. Triage and Confirmed Classification

Date received by AI Governance Lead	
Confirmed severity	Low / Medium / High / Critical
Recorded in governance records?	Yes — required for all severities; Low incidents are logged in the incident record and summarised in the AIG-OPS-02 monitoring log
Register link/status updated?	Yes / No — the AI Register holds only a link to this record and current status
Risk reclassification needed?	Yes / No

Critical-incident considerations (tick any triggered)

☐ Temporary suspension ☐ Enhanced monitoring ☐ Independent assurance review
☐ Regulatory notification ☐ Risk reclassification ☐ Additional controls / mitigations

6. Investigation

What occurred (confirmed sequence of events)

Root cause(s) — technical, data, process, control or supplier

Why governance controls did or did not detect and contain it

7. Corrective and Preventative Actions

Action	Owner	Due date	Type (corrective / preventative)

8. Notification and Closure

Personal data breach confirmed?	Yes / No / Uncertain — DPO referral made at Part A §4 (date and DPO reference); the DPO and the data breach procedure lead
Controller awareness date and time	Record when the Council had a reasonable degree of certainty that a personal data breach occurred
Risk to individuals' rights and freedoms	Assessment, rationale, assessor and date; record whether risk or high risk is likely
ICO notifiability decision and DPO advice	Notifiable / Not notifiable / Further assessment; rationale, decision owner and DPO advice reference
ICO deadline and notification reference	If notifiable, notify without undue delay and, where feasible, not later than 72 hours after becoming aware (UK GDPR Art 33); reasons for any delay must accompany a late notification. Record deadline, sent time and delay reasons
Data-subject notification decision	Required / Not required — where a high risk to individuals is likely, tell data subjects without undue delay (UK GDPR Art 34); high-risk rationale, message owner, date and evidence reference
Other regulator, contractual or partner notifications	Recipient, legal/contractual basis, deadline, owner, date and reference

Notifications made (dates)	
Specialist routes engaged (Playbook §6.8.6.5)	Tick and date each: data breach / DPO; cyber security; safeguarding; complaints; supplier / contract; corporate risk. The specialist route leads on its own duties; this record runs alongside it.
AIG-OPS-02 monitoring record updated?	Yes / No / N/A — record incident/near miss outcome and any changed monitoring requirement against the AIR-ID
Risk reassessment required?	Yes / No — mandatory documented consideration for material incidents, threshold breaches, recurring complaint patterns or adverse override trends
Residual risk / risk tier changed?	Yes / No — if Yes, update AIG-ASS-02 and current state in AIG-INV-04
Governance re-entry / Gate Log event required?	Yes / No — if Yes, record decision/event in AIG-DEC-04
Lessons learned captured?	Yes / No — fed into continuous improvement
Incident closed (date)	

AI Governance Lead name	
Signature	
Date	

Document control
Administrative control record. This artefact remains a working draft until formally approved.

Field	Controlled value
Document ID	AIG-OPS-03
Version	1.10 draft
Status	Draft for Council review
Document owner	AI Governance Lead
Approving body	Pending — competent Council authority under confirmed Constitution / Scheme of Delegation; AI Assurance Board provides assurance only unless formally delegated.
Approval date	Not yet approved
Effective date	Not yet effective
Next review date	To be set on approval: 12 months after the effective date, or sooner following material change
Classification	OFFICIAL

Change history

Version	Date	Change summary	Owner
1.0 draft	6 August 2026	Document-control baseline established following full-suite quality assurance; no substantive content change.	AI Governance Lead
1.1 draft	6 August 2026	QA revision: added near-miss classification and controller data-breach decision controls.	AI Governance Lead
1.2 draft	3 September 2026	Post-deployment QA: linked incident closure to the Monitoring and Review Log (AIG-OPS-02), risk	AI Governance Lead

Version	Date	Change summary	Owner
		reassessment, residual-risk update and governance re-entry.	
1.3 draft	26 September 2026	Aligned to the Playbook (AIG-GOV-02): severity timescales added to the escalation table; “Specialist routes engaged” row added; review point updated to record that pause/resume authority and specialist handoffs are now set out in Playbook §4.7.17 and §6.8.6.5.	AI Governance Lead
1.4 draft	29 September 2026	QA remediation — applied findings QA-011, QA-040, QA-059, QA-072, QA-091, QA-099, QA-172, QA-183, QA-185, QA-195, QA-200, QA-206, QA-221, QA-010 (see QA change log). Reporting route via Service Owner (same working day); DPO breach referral, security/safeguarding routes and external-notification question moved to Part A; Art 33/34 wording; Low incidents logged in the incident record and AIG-OPS-02; §8 reordered with closure last. Final tidy-up: self-referencing cross-reference removed from the standards row(s) REQ-033, REQ-039.	AI Governance Lead
1.5 draft	30 September 2026	v3.9.1: standards cross-reference note updated to the 54-entry requirement inventory (AIG-AIMS-05 REQ-054, Civil Contingencies Act 2004, added).	AI Governance Lead
1.6 draft	30 September 2026	v3.9.2 (pilot-readiness fixes from the scenario test; see QA change log): Part A section 4: each severity (including Low) now has its own indicator wording from Playbook §6.8.4.1, so a Low incident can be selected (T-06); the §4.7.17 mandatory triggers are escalated immediately, whatever the provisional severity, and classified at least High (W-04); new Part A row “Precautionary pause applied? Gate Log event ID” linking the pause to the AIG-DEC-04 Precautionary pause event (W-06). Proposed — for Council confirmation.	AI Governance Lead
1.7 draft	1 October 2026	v3.9.3: standards cross-reference note cites the 55-entry requirement inventory (AIG-AIMS-05 REQ-055, NIST AI 600-1 Generative AI Profile, added).	AI Governance Lead
1.8 draft	2 October 2026	v3.9.5: standards cross-reference note cites the 56-entry requirement inventory (AIG-AIMS-05 REQ-056, SI 2026/425 ICO statutory code of practice on AI and automated decision-making, added). Proposed — for Council confirmation.	AI Governance Lead
1.9 draft	3 October 2026	v3.9.8: Part A pause row names how a resumption is logged (Outcome “Resume” or “Re-authorise”); confirmation note cites AIG-DEC-04 v1.3. Proposed — for Council confirmation.	AI Governance Lead
1.10 draft	12 October 2026	v3.9.10: standards cross-reference note cites the 58-entry requirement inventory (AIG-AIMS-05 REQ-057 DAMA-DMBOK and REQ-058 ISO/IEC 5259, added as voluntary data governance references). Proposed — for Council confirmation.	AI Governance Lead

PROPOSED INTEGRATION ADDITIONS — REVIEW REQUIRED

Proposed map reference in incident triage

For an incident involving a system or component represented in AIG-INV-05, record the incident under the existing AIR-ID and cite the verified map version/Edge ID only as contextual provenance. Do not create an incident identity from a map ID or treat a map relationship as proof of cause or permission. Governance uses the evidence to reassess and, if required, creates an AIG-DEC-04 Plan or records an actual dated Event and updates AIG-INV-04 only after an authorised decision.

This integrated draft includes revisions to body content above; the annex below is supplementary proposed content for Council review. This draft and annex do not record live facts, completed actions, delegated authority, Council adoption or approval.

PROPOSED incident-to-register and re-entry linkage

Identify the system using permanent AIR-ID and obtain identity/current state from AIG-INV-04. If AIR-ID is not issued, retain provisional intake reference and route for Register-steward matching; do not invent an ID. Link incident to AIG-DEC-04 using an event reference, keeping actual occurrence, discovery, notification and response timestamps separate.

Incident report records facts, uncertainty, impact, actions and evidence; it is not an approval, finding of fault, risk reclassification or closure of a condition. Keep planned response milestones separate from actual dated AIG-DEC-04 events. Record action owner, due date, evidence and actual completion/verification date.

Material incident, near miss, control failure or significant complaint pattern triggers documented governance re-entry: relevant notification; containment/pause consideration; risk and impact reassessment; decision on refresh of AIG-ASS-03/AIG-ASS-11/AIG-OPS-02/AIG-AGT-04 and other assessments; delegated decision through AIG-DEC-03 with authoritative minutes/written-decision reference; controlled AIG-INV-04 update; and resulting gate/actions in AIG-DEC-04.

Operational containment/incident closure may coexist with open governance actions. Record both states separately. Resumption after pause requires competent delegated authority, closure or explicit authorised acceptance of relevant conditions, and controlled AIG-INV-04/AIG-DEC-04 updates.

PROPOSED material-change re-entry

Material change to purpose, model/provider, data, affected population, decision impact, authority/capabilities, integrations, environment or controls triggers documented re-entry before changed use proceeds. Where urgent change is needed to prevent harm, pause or restrict the use under Playbook §4.7.17 until the delegated decision is made. Record change, date, identifier, impact/risk review, evidence refreshed, delegated decision/effective date and updated conditions. Incident reporting does not substitute for updated intake/decision when change control is required.

Review points — not yet decided

Now set in the Playbook (AIG-GOV-02): severity timescales (§5.10.2, §6.8.4.1); pause and resume authority (§4.7.17: an immediate precautionary pause by the Service Owner, and continued suspension, resumption or withdrawal by the competent delegated authority); and handoffs to existing incident, security, safeguarding and statutory routes (§6.8.6.5). Still to confirm: named officers under the Scheme of Delegation, named contacts for each specialist route, and confirmation of the AIG-DEC-04 precautionary pause event type (AIG-DEC-04 v1.3, proposed, including the Resume outcome). No live event is asserted.

Standards and legal applicability — proposed QA cross-reference

PROPOSED QA INDEX — NOT APPROVED LEGAL ADVICE OR EVIDENCE OF COMPLIANCE. The listed instruments may be relevant to this artefact, but applicability depends on the case, service and Council delegation. Legislation, official guidance, Council policy and voluntary standards are different authority classes. The full 58-entry requirement inventory, authoritative URLs, validation owners and current versions are in AIG-AIMS-05; source checks are in AIG-AIMS-13. Do not treat a template, plan or cross-reference as completed assessment, adopted policy, ISO conformity or legal sign-off.

Requirement / instrument	Why check it here	Source
REQ-001 — UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), as amended	Where personal data is processed; test each UK GDPR provision separately.	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2016/679/contents
REQ-002 — Data Protection Act 2018, as amended	Where DPA 2018 processing/rights rules are engaged; DPO to validate.	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2018/12/contents
REQ-033 — ICO Guidance on AI and Data Protection and AI Risk Toolkit	Screen the regulatory guidance requirement against this artefact's actual use and record evidence/version.	https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/uk-gdpr-guidance-and-resources/artificial-intelligence/guidance-on-ai-and-data-protection/
REQ-039 — NCSC Guidelines for Secure AI System Development	Screen the government security guidance requirement against this artefact's actual use and	https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/guidelines-secure-ai-system-development/introduction

record evidence/version.